EXCEL + AI

5 ChatGPT Prompts That Do 2 Hours of Excel Work in 2 Minutes

5 copy-paste prompts for the Excel jobs that eat the most time: formulas, messy data, pivots, summaries and macros. Each with an example of what you get.

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Before you use any prompt

These 3 rules decide whether the answer is useful or wrong.

- **Give the structure, not the data**

  Paste column names and 5 sample rows. Never paste confidential customer or salary data.

- **Say your Excel version**

  Excel 365 has XLOOKUP, FILTER and LET. Older versions do not. The formula depends on it.

- **Always test on 3 rows**

  Check the result by hand on a few rows before filling it down 10,000 rows.

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Prompt 1: Write the formula

Replaces 20 minutes of searching forums.

```
I use Excel 365. My sheet has these columns:
A: Order Date, B: Region, C: Product, D: Amount.
Data is in rows 2 to 5000.

Write one formula for cell G2 that gives total
Amount for the Region in F2, for the month in E1
only. Explain each part in one line.
```

What you get

A SUMIFS with date range conditions, plus an explanation you can repeat in an interview.

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Prompt 2: Clean messy data

Replaces an hour of manual fixing.

```
Here are 5 sample rows from my data (paste
rows).
Problems I see: extra spaces in names, dates in
mixed formats (01/02/26 and 2026-02-01), amounts
stored as text with "Rs" and commas, and
duplicate
order IDs.

Give me step-by-step Power Query steps to fix
all
of these, in the order I should apply them.
```

What you get

A repeatable cleaning recipe. Next month you just click Refresh.

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Prompt 3: Build the pivot report

Replaces trial and error with pivot fields.

```
My columns: Date, Region, Salesperson, Product,
Quantity, Amount.

I need a monthly report for my manager showing:
revenue by region by month, each region's share
of total, and the top 3 salespeople per region.

Tell me exactly which fields go in Rows,
Columns,
Values and Filters, and which Value Field
Settings
to change.
```

What you get

The exact pivot setup, including "Show Values As % of Grand Total" and a Top 3 filter.

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Prompt 4: Write the summary

Replaces 30 minutes of writing the email that goes with the report.

```
Here is my pivot output (paste the small summary
table, not raw data).

Write 5 bullet points for a sales head:
- the biggest change vs last month, with numbers
- the best and worst region
- one risk to watch
- one recommended action
Plain language, no jargon, under 120 words.
```

What you get

A first draft you edit in 2 minutes. Always check every number against the table.

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Prompt 5: Automate the repeat work

For the task you do every week the same way.

```
I do this every Monday in Excel:
1. Open the file "weekly_sales.xlsx"
2. Delete rows where Status = "Cancelled"
3. Sort by Region, then Amount descending
4. Add a total row at the bottom
5. Save as "report_<today's date>.xlsx"

Write a VBA macro that does all 5 steps. Add a
comment above each block. Tell me how to run it.
```

What you get

A macro you run with one click. Test it on a copy of the file first.

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Where the 2 hours go

A typical weekly report, before and after.

- **Finding the right formula**
  20-30 min before. Prompt 1: 2 min.
- **Cleaning the data**
  40-60 min before. Prompt 2 once, then Refresh every week.
- **Setting up the pivot**
  15-20 min before. Prompt 3: 2 min.
- **Writing the summary**
  20-30 min before. Prompt 4: 2 min plus a check.
- **Repeating it next week**
  Prompt 5 turns the whole routine into one click.

The rule: AI writes the first draft. You check the numbers. Never send an AI-written number you have not verified.

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